

Exploring the drivers of impulsive buying in e-commerce: the role of hedonic motivation, shopping lifestyle, and positive emotions

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Received: 03-06-2025 | Revision: 22-08-2025 | Accepted: 10-10-2025 | Published: 15-10-2025

DOI: <https://doi.org/10.22219/jiko.v10i02.35353>

Abstract

The rapid expansion of e-commerce has transformed fashion consumption and created new opportunities for consumers to engage in unplanned purchasing. This study examines the effects of hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle on impulse buying and investigates the mediating role of positive emotions among consumers purchasing fashion products through e-commerce in Indonesia. A quantitative causal research design was employed using data from 140 respondents selected through purposive sampling. The data were analyzed using Partial Least Squares Structural Equation Modeling (PLS-SEM) with SmartPLS. The results show that hedonic motivation has a positive and significant effect on impulse buying and positive emotions. Shopping lifestyle also has a positive and significant effect on both impulse buying and positive emotions. Furthermore, positive emotions significantly increase impulse buying and represent the strongest direct relationship in the structural model. The mediation analysis confirms that positive emotions significantly mediate the relationships between hedonic motivation and impulse buying and between shopping lifestyle and impulse buying. The model explains 56.3% of the variance in impulse buying. These findings indicate that impulse buying in fashion e-commerce is shaped not only by consumers' shopping orientations but also by their emotional experiences. The study highlights the importance of integrating motivational, lifestyle, and affective factors to understand spontaneous purchasing behavior in digital fashion consumption.

Keywords: impulse buying; hedonic motivation; e-commerce; fashion



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1. Introduction

The rapid expansion of e-commerce has fundamentally changed the way consumers search for, evaluate, and purchase products. Digital shopping environments provide consumers with continuous access to products, personalized recommendations, promotions, social information, and highly convenient purchasing processes. These characteristics have made online consumption increasingly embedded in everyday life and have simultaneously created new opportunities for retailers to influence consumers' purchasing decisions (Chan et al., 2017; Yang et al., 2021; Zafar et al., 2020). In Indonesia, this transformation is particularly relevant because e-commerce has become an important component of the digital economy. The continued expansion of Indonesia's digital consumer base has strengthened the importance of understanding how consumers respond psychologically and behaviorally to online shopping stimuli. Recent evidence also indicates that Indonesian consumers increasingly engage with digital content and commerce, including fashion-related content, reinforcing the strategic importance of understanding online fashion consumption.

Among the various categories traded through e-commerce, fashion represents a particularly important context for examining consumer behavior. Fashion products are closely associated not only with functional needs but also with identity, appearance, self-expression, social recognition, and enjoyment. Consequently, fashion consumption may involve a stronger emotional and experiential component than purchasing decisions based exclusively on utilitarian considerations. The original study indicates that fashion products account for a substantial proportion of Indonesian consumers' online shopping preferences and that the Indonesian fashion e-commerce market represents a sizeable component of the broader e-commerce economy. Although online fashion purchases involve potential risks—including differences between displayed and received products, uncertainty regarding size and color, delivery delays, and seller responsiveness—consumers continue to purchase fashion products through e-commerce platforms. This apparent coexistence of perceived risk and spontaneous purchasing behavior raises an important question: why do consumers continue to make unplanned fashion purchases in an environment where the consequences of an inappropriate purchase may be relatively difficult to evaluate before consumption?

One important explanation is impulse buying. Impulse buying refers to a purchase that occurs without substantial prior planning and is characterized by a sudden urge to acquire a product. Unlike planned purchasing, impulse buying involves limited deliberation and is frequently associated with affective reactions and situational stimuli (Zheng et al., 2019; Wu et al., 2020). The phenomenon is particularly relevant in digital environments because e-commerce platforms reduce the temporal and physical barriers between product exposure and purchase. Consumers can move from browsing to transaction within a few clicks, while promotional messages, product recommendations, social cues, and interface characteristics can simultaneously stimulate purchasing responses (Kimiagari & Asadi Malafe, 2021; Yang et al., 2021). A meta-analysis by Iyer et al. (2020), based on 231 samples and more than 75,000 consumers, further demonstrates that impulse buying is shaped by a combination of internal psychological factors and external market-related stimuli.

The online environment therefore makes the psychological mechanisms underlying impulse buying particularly important. Previous research has established that online impulse buying cannot be explained solely by economic or functional considerations. Instead, consumers' cognitive and affective responses play an important role in translating shopping stimuli into impulsive purchasing behavior (Chan et al., 2017; Kimiagari & Asadi Malafe, 2021). Research based on the Stimulus–Organism–Response perspective suggests that external stimuli encountered during online shopping can influence consumers' internal states, which subsequently affect behavioral responses. More recent research likewise demonstrates that consumers' online shopping experiences can influence impulsive purchasing through both functional and psychological mechanisms. Thus, understanding impulse buying requires attention not only to the purchasing outcome but also to the psychological conditions that precede it.

Within this perspective, hedonic motivation is an important internal factor. Hedonic motivation reflects consumers' desire to obtain pleasure, enjoyment, entertainment, and experiential value from shopping rather than merely satisfying functional needs (Erdem & Yilmaz, 2021). Consumers with stronger hedonic motivations may perceive shopping as an enjoyable activity in itself, increasing their willingness to explore products and respond spontaneously to attractive offerings. Previous empirical evidence has consistently associated hedonic motivations with impulse buying, including in online and social-commerce environments (Iyer et al., 2020; Kimiagari & Asadi Malafe, 2021). Research involving Indonesian consumers also suggests that hedonic motivation can be an important determinant of impulsive purchasing intentions in digital commerce. Accordingly, consumers who approach fashion shopping as a source of pleasure may be more susceptible to unplanned purchasing decisions.

A second important factor is shopping lifestyle. Shopping lifestyle reflects the extent to which shopping activities constitute an important part of consumers' daily lifestyles and how individuals allocate their resources, time, and attention to shopping activities. In the context of fashion, shopping may become intertwined with self-image, social identity, and changing trends. Consumers who strongly identify with shopping as a lifestyle may therefore be more attentive to new products, fashion trends, promotional offers, and opportunities for consumption. Previous studies have found a positive association between shopping lifestyle and impulse buying, particularly in fashion-related consumption contexts (Japariato & Sugiharto, 2012; Nurtanio et al., 2022; Ummah & Rahayu, 2020). The original study similarly positions shopping lifestyle as a major antecedent of impulse buying among fashion consumers in e-commerce.

However, hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle may not influence impulse buying exclusively through a direct behavioral pathway. Positive emotions may represent an important psychological mechanism linking consumers' motivational characteristics to their purchasing behavior. Positive emotions include feelings such as pleasure, excitement, happiness, and enjoyment that arise during the consumption or shopping process. Such emotional states can reduce deliberative evaluation and strengthen consumers' immediate desire to acquire a product. Previous research has identified positive affect as an important mechanism in impulse buying, while studies of online consumption have emphasized the role of affective responses in translating shopping stimuli into behavioral outcomes (Park & Lennon, 2006; Iyer et al., 2020; Kimiagari & Asadi Malafe, 2021). Recent evidence also indicates that emotional responses can interact with situational and personal factors to strengthen impulsive behavior in e-commerce environments.

Despite the substantial literature on impulse buying, an important empirical issue remains. Much of the existing research examines impulse buying through individual antecedents, platform stimuli, promotional mechanisms, or general consumer characteristics. Although prior studies have established relationships between hedonic motivation, shopping lifestyle, positive emotions, and impulse buying, these constructs are not always examined simultaneously within the same empirical framework, particularly in the context of Indonesian fashion e-commerce. The literature review by Chan et al. (2017) demonstrated that online impulse buying is a multidimensional phenomenon involving relationships among external stimuli, internal psychological states, and behavioral responses. More recent studies continue to identify affective mechanisms as an important but context-dependent component of online impulse buying. This suggests the need for further empirical examination of whether positive emotions function as a psychological pathway through which hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle translate into impulsive purchasing.

This study therefore examines the relationships among hedonic motivation, shopping lifestyle, positive emotions, and impulse buying among consumers purchasing fashion products through e-commerce in Indonesia. More specifically, the study investigates whether hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle are associated with impulse buying, whether these two factors influence positive emotions, whether positive emotions directly influence impulse buying, and whether positive emotions mediate the relationships between hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle and impulse buying. By integrating motivational, lifestyle, and affective dimensions within a single empirical model, the study seeks to provide a more coherent explanation of why consumers engage in impulsive fashion purchases in e-commerce environments.

The study contributes to the existing literature in two ways. First, it strengthens the understanding of impulse buying by examining motivational and lifestyle factors together with the affective mechanism represented by positive emotions. Second, it provides empirical evidence from the Indonesian fashion e-commerce context, where digital shopping has expanded rapidly but consumers continue to face uncertainty regarding product suitability and transaction outcomes. The findings are also expected to provide practical implications for e-commerce retailers and fashion businesses seeking to understand consumer responses to experiential and emotional aspects of online shopping. In this way, the study moves beyond the simple observation that consumers purchase impulsively and instead examines how and through which psychological mechanism hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle contribute to impulse buying.

2. Literature Review

2.1 Impulse Buying in E-Commerce

Impulse buying represents a distinctive form of consumer decision-making characterized by an immediate purchase response that occurs with limited prior planning and deliberation. Unlike planned purchasing, in which consumers typically evaluate alternatives before deciding to buy, impulse buying emerges from a sudden urge to purchase and is often accompanied by strong affective responses (Rook, 1987; Beatty & Ferrell, 1998). The phenomenon is therefore not

merely a consequence of insufficient planning but reflects an interaction between consumers' internal psychological states and situational shopping stimuli.

The relevance of impulse buying has become increasingly pronounced in e-commerce. Digital shopping environments reduce the temporal and physical distance between product exposure and transaction, allowing consumers to move rapidly from browsing to purchasing. Online platforms also provide continuous product availability, personalized recommendations, social information, promotions, and convenient payment mechanisms that can intensify consumers' responses to shopping stimuli (Zheng et al., 2019; Wu et al., 2020; Yang et al., 2021). Consequently, the digital environment may facilitate impulse buying by reducing opportunities for extensive deliberation while simultaneously increasing exposure to stimuli that generate purchase desire.

The broader literature confirms that impulse buying is a multidimensional phenomenon. Iyer et al. (2020), through a meta-analysis encompassing 231 samples and more than 75,000 consumers, demonstrate that impulse buying is associated with both internal psychological determinants and external market-related stimuli. This finding is important because it indicates that impulse buying should not be explained solely by characteristics of the retail environment. Consumers' motivations, emotions, lifestyles, and psychological dispositions can determine how strongly they respond to external shopping stimuli.

This perspective is particularly relevant to fashion e-commerce. Fashion products frequently possess symbolic and experiential value in addition to functional value. Consumers may purchase fashion products to express identity, follow trends, obtain pleasure, or enhance their perceived social image. Consequently, fashion shopping can involve stronger emotional and hedonic responses than purchases driven primarily by functional necessity. Research in the Indonesian context has similarly documented the importance of shopping lifestyle, hedonic motivation, fashion involvement, and positive emotions in explaining impulse buying behavior in e-commerce.

Thus, impulse buying in e-commerce can be conceptualized as the behavioral outcome of an interaction between consumers' predispositions and their affective responses to the shopping experience. This conceptualization provides the basis for examining hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle as antecedents and positive emotions as an important psychological mechanism.

2.2 Hedonic Motivation and Impulse Buying

Hedonic motivation refers to the extent to which consumers engage in shopping because of pleasure, enjoyment, excitement, entertainment, and experiential gratification rather than solely because of utilitarian needs. The distinction between utilitarian and hedonic consumption is important because shopping can function not only as a means of acquiring products but also as an enjoyable experience in itself. Consumers motivated by hedonic considerations are therefore more likely to value the process of browsing and purchasing, independent of whether the product was originally planned to be purchased.

The relationship between hedonic motivation and impulse buying can be understood through the affective nature of impulsive consumption. A consumer who perceives shopping as enjoyable may be more responsive to attractive products, novel designs, promotional cues, and other stimuli encountered during browsing. The desire to maintain or intensify the pleasurable shopping experience can reduce the importance of prior purchase planning and increase the likelihood of spontaneous purchasing (Verplanken & Herabadi, 2001; Kimiagari & Asadi Malafe, 2021).

In online environments, this mechanism can become particularly salient. Kimiagari and Asadi Malafe (2021) demonstrate that cognitive and affective responses play important roles in explaining online impulse buying. Their findings support the view that impulse buying emerges not simply from rational evaluation but also from consumers' emotional reactions during the shopping process. Similarly, Zheng et al. (2019) show that hedonic browsing is relevant to understanding impulse buying in mobile commerce, highlighting the importance of the experiential dimension of digital shopping.

The broader evidence is consistent with the meta-analytic findings of Iyer et al. (2020), which identify internal psychological factors as important determinants of impulse buying. In this context, hedonic motivation represents an internal predisposition that makes consumers more receptive to pleasurable shopping experiences and, consequently, more likely to respond impulsively when an attractive purchasing opportunity emerges.

The relationship is also relevant in fashion consumption. Fashion products frequently provide symbolic and experiential benefits that extend beyond functional utility. Consumers may derive pleasure from discovering new designs, imagining themselves using particular products, or following contemporary fashion trends. Therefore, when shopping motivation is primarily hedonic, the distinction between browsing for enjoyment and purchasing for necessity

becomes less pronounced. This condition can increase the likelihood that consumers will translate a pleasurable shopping experience into an unplanned purchase.

H1: Hedonic motivation has a positive and significant effect on impulse buying.

2.3 Hedonic Motivation and Positive Emotions

Hedonic motivation is also theoretically connected to consumers' emotional responses during shopping. Because hedonic shopping is oriented toward pleasure and experiential gratification, consumers who possess stronger hedonic motivation are expected to experience stronger positive emotional responses when engaging with attractive products or enjoyable shopping environments.

Positive emotions represent affective states such as pleasure, excitement, happiness, and enjoyment that consumers experience during shopping. In an e-commerce context, these emotions may emerge from product discovery, visual presentation, perceived attractiveness, entertainment, convenience, or the anticipation of owning a desirable product. Such affective experiences can become an important psychological consequence of consumers' hedonic orientation.

Previous research supports the association between hedonic motivation and positive emotional responses. Kimiagari and Asadi Malafe (2021) emphasize the importance of affective responses in online impulse buying, while research examining Indonesian e-commerce consumers has found that hedonic shopping motivation is positively associated with positive emotions. The original study likewise proposes that consumers who shop for pleasure and enjoyment are more likely to experience positive emotional states during the shopping process.

The relationship can be explained by the experiential nature of hedonic consumption. When consumers perceive shopping as intrinsically rewarding, the shopping process itself becomes a source of emotional gratification. Consequently, stronger hedonic motivation should increase the likelihood that consumers experience positive emotions during online fashion shopping.

H2: Hedonic motivation has a positive and significant effect on positive emotions.

2.4 Shopping Lifestyle and Impulse Buying

Shopping lifestyle describes the extent to which shopping becomes an important component of an individual's lifestyle and reflects how consumers allocate their time, money, and attention to shopping activities. Unlike a temporary shopping intention, shopping lifestyle represents a more enduring orientation toward shopping as an activity that can provide satisfaction, identity, and social meaning.

The relevance of shopping lifestyle to impulse buying becomes particularly evident in fashion consumption. Fashion is characterized by continuous changes in styles, designs, trends, and consumer preferences. Consumers with a strong shopping-oriented lifestyle may therefore pay greater attention to new products and fashion developments and may be more frequently exposed to opportunities that stimulate unplanned purchases. Shopping itself can become part of the consumer's lifestyle rather than merely a means of fulfilling a specific need.

Previous empirical studies have identified a positive relationship between shopping lifestyle and impulse buying. Japarianto and Sugiharto (2012) demonstrated the relevance of shopping lifestyle to impulse buying behavior among high-income consumers in Surabaya, while Nurtanio et al. (2022) found that shopping lifestyle and hedonic shopping motivation were associated with impulse buying among Bukalapak consumers. Similarly, Ummah and Rahayu (2020) reported the relevance of shopping lifestyle to impulsive purchases of fashion products.

Recent evidence from the Indonesian fashion industry provides additional support. Zein and Hadi (2025) found that shopping lifestyle has a positive and significant effect on impulse buying among consumers of an Indonesian fashion brand. This evidence strengthens the argument that shopping lifestyle remains relevant in contemporary digital fashion consumption.

From a behavioral perspective, consumers who regard shopping as an important lifestyle activity are likely to spend more time browsing and evaluating products. Greater exposure to shopping stimuli increases opportunities for spontaneous purchase decisions. In addition, a strong shopping orientation may reduce the psychological distance between desire and action, making consumers more willing to transform a temporary purchase urge into an actual transaction.

H3: Shopping lifestyle has a positive and significant effect on impulse buying.

2.5 Shopping Lifestyle and Positive Emotions

Shopping lifestyle is also expected to influence consumers' emotional experiences. When shopping is integrated into an individual's lifestyle, the activity can become a source of enjoyment and emotional gratification. Consumers who frequently engage in shopping activities may derive pleasure from discovering products, following trends, comparing alternatives, and participating in consumption experiences.

This relationship is especially relevant to fashion because fashion consumption frequently involves symbolic and experiential dimensions. Consumers may experience positive emotions when they discover products that correspond to their desired appearance, social identity, or personal preferences. Therefore, shopping lifestyle may influence not only the frequency of shopping activities but also the emotional value consumers derive from those activities.

Empirical evidence supports this argument. Research involving Indonesian e-commerce consumers has found that shopping lifestyle is positively associated with positive emotions. Similar evidence has been reported in studies examining fashion and shopping behavior, where engagement with fashion and shopping activities is associated with pleasurable and affective consumer experiences.

The theoretical implication is that shopping lifestyle may create a psychological environment in which consumers are more likely to experience positive emotions during shopping. When shopping becomes an enjoyable and meaningful part of everyday life, the emotional benefits associated with the activity can become an important mechanism connecting lifestyle orientation with subsequent purchasing behavior.

H4: Shopping lifestyle has a positive and significant effect on positive emotions.

2.6 Positive Emotions and Impulse Buying

Positive emotions constitute one of the most important psychological mechanisms in impulse buying. Impulse purchases are frequently characterized by an immediate urge and a reduced emphasis on extensive cognitive evaluation. Positive emotional states can strengthen this immediate orientation by increasing consumers' desire for gratification and reducing the perceived importance of delaying the purchase.

The relationship between emotion and impulse buying has been recognized in the foundational impulse-buying literature. Beatty and Ferrell (1998) identified affective states as important determinants of impulse buying behavior, while Park and Lennon (2006) demonstrated the relevance of psychological and environmental antecedents in impulse buying within a multichannel shopping context. More recent research confirms that affective responses remain central to understanding online impulse buying, particularly when consumers encounter stimulating shopping environments (Kimiagari & Asadi Malafe, 2021; Iyer et al., 2020).

The relationship is particularly meaningful in e-commerce because digital shopping environments can generate rapid emotional responses while simultaneously making transactions highly convenient. A consumer who experiences pleasure, excitement, or enthusiasm toward a product can act immediately without the delays associated with conventional shopping. This interaction between positive affect and transaction convenience creates conditions under which emotional reactions can be translated quickly into purchasing behavior.

Evidence from Indonesia is consistent with this theoretical expectation. Recent research in the Indonesian fashion industry finds that positive emotion has a positive and significant effect on impulse buying. The original study also reports a significant positive relationship between positive emotions and impulse buying.

Accordingly, positive emotional states are expected to increase the probability that consumers will convert an immediate desire into an actual unplanned purchase.

H5: Positive emotions have a positive and significant effect on impulse buying.

2.7 Positive Emotions as a Mediating Mechanism

The preceding discussion suggests that the relationships among hedonic motivation, shopping lifestyle, positive emotions, and impulse buying should not be viewed exclusively as independent direct effects. Instead, positive emotions may provide an important psychological pathway through which consumers' motivational and lifestyle orientations are translated into impulsive purchasing behavior.

The logic of this mediation mechanism is straightforward. First, consumers with stronger hedonic motivation are more likely to seek pleasure and enjoyment from shopping. This orientation can increase positive emotional

responses during the shopping process. Second, consumers with a stronger shopping lifestyle are more likely to regard shopping as an important and enjoyable activity, which can similarly enhance positive emotions. Third, positive emotions can strengthen the immediate desire to purchase and reduce the tendency to engage in extensive deliberation. Therefore, hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle may influence impulse buying partly because they increase the positive emotional state experienced during shopping.

This mechanism is consistent with the broader literature emphasizing the interaction between internal consumer characteristics, affective states, and behavioral responses. Iyer et al. (2020) demonstrate that impulse buying is influenced by multiple psychological and environmental determinants rather than by a single antecedent. Kimiagari and Asadi Malafe (2021) likewise highlight the importance of cognitive and affective responses in online impulse buying. The more recent systematic literature on digital impulse buying further reinforces the importance of integrating psychological mechanisms into explanations of online purchasing behavior.

Empirical evidence from Indonesia provides additional support for this mediation perspective. Research in the fashion industry has found that positive emotion mediates the relationship between shopping lifestyle and impulse buying. Similarly, the original study finds significant indirect relationships between hedonic motivation and impulse buying and between shopping lifestyle and impulse buying through positive emotions.

Therefore, positive emotions can be positioned as the psychological mechanism connecting consumers' internal shopping orientation with their behavioral response. This positioning also provides a more integrated explanation of impulse buying than models that examine only direct relationships between shopping characteristics and purchasing outcomes.

H6: Positive emotions significantly mediate the relationship between hedonic motivation and impulse buying.

H7: Positive emotions significantly mediate the relationship between shopping lifestyle and impulse buying.

2.8 Conceptual Synthesis

Taken together, the literature suggests that impulse buying in fashion e-commerce is shaped by the interaction between consumers' motivational orientation, lifestyle, and emotional state. Hedonic motivation reflects the desire to obtain pleasure from shopping, while shopping lifestyle represents the extent to which shopping is incorporated into consumers' everyday consumption orientation. Both characteristics are expected to increase positive emotional responses during shopping. Positive emotions, in turn, are expected to increase consumers' propensity to make impulsive purchases.

The conceptual framework therefore positions hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle as antecedents, positive emotions as a mediating psychological mechanism, and impulse buying as the behavioral outcome. This framework allows the study to examine both direct and indirect relationships and provides an integrated explanation of impulsive fashion purchasing in the Indonesian e-commerce context.

The resulting research model consists of seven hypotheses: five direct-effect hypotheses and two mediation hypotheses. This framework is consistent with the empirical structure of the original study while providing a stronger theoretical rationale for each proposed relationship.

3. Method

3.1 Research Design and Participants

This study employed a quantitative causal research design to examine the relationships among hedonic motivation, shopping lifestyle, positive emotions, and impulse buying in the context of fashion e-commerce. The research focused on consumers who had purchased fashion products impulsively through e-commerce platforms.

A total of 140 respondents participated in the study. Respondents were selected using purposive sampling based on two criteria: (1) they had experienced impulsive purchasing of fashion products through an e-commerce platform, and (2) they purchased products through e-commerce at least once a month. The sample size followed the study's original sampling procedure based on the number of measurement indicators.

3.2 Measures

The study examined four constructs: hedonic motivation, shopping lifestyle, positive emotions, and impulse buying. Each construct was measured using multiple indicators adapted from established consumer-behavior literature. The measurement items were assessed using a structured questionnaire administered to the selected respondents.

Hedonic motivation captured the extent to which consumers engage in shopping for pleasure, enjoyment, and experiential gratification. Shopping lifestyle represented consumers' orientation toward shopping as an important part of their consumption activities. Positive emotions captured consumers' pleasurable and favorable emotional responses during shopping, while impulse buying represented unplanned and spontaneous purchasing behavior.

3.3 Data Analysis

The data were analyzed using Partial Least Squares Structural Equation Modeling (PLS-SEM) with SmartPLS. The analysis was conducted in two stages. First, the measurement model was assessed to establish the validity and reliability of the constructs. Convergent validity was evaluated using indicator loadings and Average Variance Extracted (AVE), while construct reliability was assessed using composite reliability and Cronbach's alpha.

Second, the structural model was evaluated to examine the hypothesized relationships among the constructs. The analysis considered the explanatory power of the model through the coefficient of determination (R^2) and assessed the significance and direction of the hypothesized relationships using the estimated path coefficients and bootstrapping-based significance tests. The mediation analysis was subsequently conducted to determine whether positive emotions mediated the relationships between hedonic motivation and impulse buying and between shopping lifestyle and impulse buying.

The analytical procedure was designed to provide evidence for both the direct effects of hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle on impulse buying and their indirect effects through positive emotions.

4. Empirical Result

4.1 Measurement and Structural Model Assessment

The analysis was conducted using Partial Least Squares Structural Equation Modeling (PLS-SEM). The assessment began with the measurement model to establish the validity and reliability of the four constructs, followed by evaluation of the structural relationships and mediation effects.

The measurement results indicate satisfactory convergent validity across all constructs. All indicator loadings exceeded the commonly accepted threshold of 0.70, ranging from 0.728 to 0.957. The Average Variance Extracted (AVE) values ranged from 0.703 to 0.826, indicating that each construct explained a substantial proportion of the variance in its respective indicators. Construct reliability was also established, with composite reliability ranging from 0.904 to 0.934 and Cronbach's alpha ranging from 0.845 to 0.895. These results indicate that the measurement instruments demonstrated adequate validity and internal consistency.

The structural model produced an R^2 of 0.563 for impulse buying and 0.223 for positive emotions. Thus, the model explained 56.3% of the variance in impulse buying and 22.3% of the variance in positive emotions. The results indicate a moderate explanatory capacity for impulse buying and a comparatively lower explanatory capacity for positive emotions.

The hypothesis-testing results show that all proposed direct relationships are positive and statistically significant. Hedonic motivation positively affects impulse buying ($\beta = 0.262$, $p < 0.001$) and positive emotions ($\beta = 0.256$, $p = 0.011$). Shopping lifestyle also has a positive effect on impulse buying ($\beta = 0.315$, $p < 0.001$) and positive emotions ($\beta = 0.296$, $p = 0.001$). Positive emotions exert the strongest direct effect on impulse buying among the tested relationships ($\beta = 0.378$, $p < 0.001$).

The mediation analysis further demonstrates that positive emotions significantly mediate both relationships examined. The indirect effect of hedonic motivation on impulse buying through positive emotions is significant ($t = 2.373$, $p = 0.018$), while the indirect effect of shopping lifestyle on impulse buying through positive emotions is also significant ($t = 2.852$, $p = 0.005$). Accordingly, all seven hypotheses proposed in the study are supported.

Table 1. Summary of Measurement and Structural Model Results

Assessment	Relationship Construct /	Result	Interpretation
Outer loading	Impulsive Buying	0.869–0.876	Valid
Outer loading	Positive Emotions	0.779–0.926	Valid
Outer loading	Hedonic Motivation	0.728–0.906	Valid
Outer loading	Shopping Lifestyle	0.808–0.957	Valid
AVE	Impulsive Buying	0.759	Valid
AVE	Positive Emotions	0.766	Valid
AVE	Hedonic Motivation	0.703	Valid
AVE	Shopping Lifestyle	0.826	Valid
Composite Reliability	Impulsive Buying	0.927	Reliable
Composite Reliability	Positive Emotions	0.907	Reliable
Composite Reliability	Hedonic Motivation	0.904	Reliable
Composite Reliability	Shopping Lifestyle	0.934	Reliable
Cronbach's Alpha	Impulsive Buying	0.895	Reliable
Cronbach's Alpha	Positive Emotions	0.845	Reliable
Cronbach's Alpha	Hedonic Motivation	0.856	Reliable
Cronbach's Alpha	Shopping Lifestyle	0.891	Reliable
R ²	Impulsive Buying	0.563	Moderate explanatory power
R ²	Positive Emotions	0.223	Lower explanatory power
H1	Hedonic Motivation → Impulse Buying	$\beta = 0.262$; $t = 3.631$; $p < 0.001$	Supported
H2	Hedonic Motivation → Positive Emotions	$\beta = 0.256$; $t = 2.550$; $p = 0.011$	Supported
H3	Shopping Lifestyle → Impulse Buying	$\beta = 0.315$; $t = 4.183$; $p < 0.001$	Supported
H4	Shopping Lifestyle → Positive Emotions	$\beta = 0.296$; $t = 3.374$; $p = 0.001$	Supported
H5	Positive Emotions → Impulse Buying	$\beta = 0.378$; $t = 5.001$; $p < 0.001$	Supported
H6	Hedonic Motivation → Positive Emotions → Impulse Buying	$t = 2.373$; $p = 0.018$	Supported
H7	Shopping Lifestyle → Positive Emotions → Impulse Buying	$t = 2.852$; $p = 0.005$	Supported

Note. β = standardized path coefficient; t = t-statistic; p = significance probability; AVE = Average Variance Extracted; R² = coefficient of determination. The values are based on the original SmartPLS results.

Overall, the results provide consistent evidence that both hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle are important antecedents of impulse buying in fashion e-commerce. Their effects are not limited to direct behavioral outcomes; both variables also significantly increase positive emotions during the shopping process.

Among the direct effects, positive emotions exhibit the largest coefficient ($\beta = 0.378$), exceeding the effects of shopping lifestyle ($\beta = 0.315$) and hedonic motivation ($\beta = 0.262$) on impulse buying. This finding indicates that the emotional state experienced during shopping is particularly relevant to consumers' impulsive purchasing behavior.

The mediation results provide additional evidence that positive emotions constitute an important mechanism connecting consumers' shopping orientations with impulse buying. Both indirect relationships are statistically

significant, indicating that consumers' hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle contribute to impulse buying partly through the positive emotional responses generated during the shopping experience.

Taken together, the findings support the proposed conceptual framework: hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle influence impulse buying both directly and indirectly through positive emotions. The model explains more than half of the variance in impulse buying ($R^2 = 0.563$), indicating that the combination of motivational, lifestyle, and affective factors provides meaningful explanatory power for impulsive fashion purchases in the e-commerce context.

5. Discussion

5.1 Hedonic Motivation and Impulse Buying

The findings demonstrate that hedonic motivation has a positive and significant effect on impulse buying. This result indicates that consumers who perceive shopping as a source of pleasure, enjoyment, and experiential gratification are more likely to make unplanned fashion purchases in e-commerce. The finding supports the fundamental view of impulse buying that purchasing behavior is not determined exclusively by functional needs or rational evaluation but is also shaped by consumers' affective and experiential motivations (Rook, 1987; Verplanken & Herabadi, 2001).

The result is consistent with previous empirical evidence showing that hedonic motivation is an important determinant of impulse buying. Kimiagari and Asadi Malafe (2021) demonstrate that affective and cognitive responses play an important role in online impulse buying, while Zheng et al. (2019) show that hedonic browsing is associated with impulsive purchasing in mobile commerce. The broader meta-analysis by Iyer et al. (2020) similarly establishes the importance of internal psychological factors in explaining impulse buying across different consumption contexts. These findings suggest that consumers do not necessarily enter an e-commerce platform with a predetermined intention to purchase a particular fashion product. Instead, shopping may itself become a pleasurable activity that creates opportunities for spontaneous purchasing.

The fashion context provides an especially plausible explanation for this relationship. Fashion products can provide experiential and symbolic benefits beyond their functional utility. Consumers may browse fashion products because they enjoy discovering new designs, imagining alternative appearances, following trends, or expressing personal identity. Consequently, when shopping is driven by hedonic motivation, the boundary between browsing for enjoyment and purchasing for need becomes less distinct. The present finding is therefore consistent with previous Indonesian research showing that hedonic shopping motivation is positively associated with impulse buying in e-commerce contexts.

The result also has an important theoretical implication. Hedonic motivation should not be interpreted simply as a preference for expensive or non-essential consumption. Rather, it represents a psychological orientation toward the shopping experience itself. In this sense, impulse buying can emerge because the act of purchasing provides immediate experiential gratification. This interpretation strengthens the argument that impulse buying in digital fashion commerce is partly an affective and experiential phenomenon rather than merely a response to promotional stimuli.

5.2 Hedonic Motivation and Positive Emotions

The results further show that hedonic motivation has a positive and significant effect on positive emotions. This finding indicates that consumers who approach shopping as an enjoyable and pleasurable activity are more likely to experience favorable emotional states during the shopping process. The relationship is theoretically coherent because hedonic motivation implies that consumers seek emotional gratification from shopping rather than treating shopping solely as an instrumental activity.

This result is consistent with research emphasizing the role of affective responses in online shopping behavior. Kimiagari and Asadi Malafe (2021) argue that affective responses are an important component of online impulse buying, while previous research in the Indonesian e-commerce context has also found that hedonic shopping motivation contributes positively to positive emotions. Thus, the present findings reinforce the view that consumers' emotional experiences are partly rooted in their underlying motivations for engaging in shopping.

The result can also be interpreted from the experiential characteristics of fashion consumption. Fashion browsing may generate excitement through exposure to new collections, attractive visual presentations, changing trends, and the anticipation of using a desired product. For consumers with a strong hedonic orientation, these experiences may be particularly salient because pleasure is itself one of the objectives of shopping. Positive emotions therefore represent a natural psychological response to hedonic shopping motivation.

Importantly, the finding establishes the first part of the proposed mediation mechanism. Hedonic motivation does not only have a direct behavioral relationship with impulse buying; it is also associated with the emotional state

that subsequently becomes relevant to purchasing behavior. This provides a more complete explanation of how hedonic motivation may translate into spontaneous purchasing.

5.3 Shopping Lifestyle and Impulse Buying

The findings indicate that shopping lifestyle has a positive and significant effect on impulse buying. Consumers for whom shopping constitutes an important part of their lifestyle are therefore more likely to engage in unplanned fashion purchases. This result is consistent with the conceptualization of shopping lifestyle as an orientation that influences how individuals allocate their time, attention, and financial resources to shopping activities.

The finding is supported by previous research in both conventional and digital fashion contexts. Japarianto and Sugiharto (2012) identified shopping lifestyle as an important factor associated with impulse buying among consumers in Surabaya, while Nurtanio et al. (2022) reported a positive relationship between shopping lifestyle and impulse buying among Bukalapak consumers. Research on Indonesian e-commerce has similarly found that shopping lifestyle significantly influences impulse buying.

The finding is also consistent with more recent evidence from the Indonesian fashion industry. Zein and Hadi (2025) found that shopping lifestyle has a positive and significant effect on impulse buying among fashion consumers, while positive emotion also plays a significant role in the same behavioral process. This convergence is important because it indicates that the relevance of shopping lifestyle is not restricted to traditional retail settings but remains observable in contemporary digital fashion consumption.

From a behavioral perspective, consumers with a strong shopping lifestyle are likely to have greater exposure to products, trends, promotions, and other shopping stimuli because shopping is incorporated more deeply into their daily activities. Greater exposure creates more opportunities for spontaneous purchasing. In addition, repeated engagement with shopping may make purchasing decisions more automatic and less dependent on extensive pre-purchase planning.

The present result therefore suggests that impulse buying should also be understood as an expression of consumers' broader consumption orientation. A shopping-oriented lifestyle can create a behavioral environment in which spontaneous purchases become more acceptable and more likely to occur.

5.4 Shopping Lifestyle and Positive Emotions

Shopping lifestyle also has a positive and significant effect on positive emotions. This finding indicates that consumers who integrate shopping more strongly into their lifestyle tend to experience more favorable emotional responses during the shopping process. The result supports the argument that shopping can function not only as a means of acquiring products but also as a source of enjoyment and emotional gratification.

The finding is consistent with previous Indonesian evidence showing that shopping lifestyle positively influences positive emotions in e-commerce. Dewi and Adi (2023), for example, found significant positive effects of shopping lifestyle and hedonic shopping motivation on positive emotions among Tokopedia consumers. This suggests that shopping lifestyle has an affective dimension that extends beyond purchase frequency or expenditure.

In the context of fashion, this relationship may be particularly strong because shopping activities are closely connected to trends, appearance, identity, and social expression. Consumers who regard shopping as an important lifestyle activity may derive satisfaction from discovering new products, keeping up with fashion developments, and constructing preferred identities through consumption. These experiences can generate positive emotional states even before the actual purchase takes place.

The finding is therefore important for understanding the subsequent relationship between shopping lifestyle and impulse buying. If shopping lifestyle increases positive emotions, and positive emotions subsequently increase impulse buying, then emotional experience provides a plausible mechanism through which lifestyle orientation is translated into purchasing behavior.

5.5 Positive Emotions and Impulse Buying

Among the direct relationships examined in the study, positive emotions have the largest standardized effect on impulse buying ($\beta = 0.378$). This result indicates that the emotional state experienced during shopping is particularly important in explaining consumers' spontaneous purchasing behavior. The finding is consistent with the established literature on impulse buying, which emphasizes the role of affective reactions in reducing deliberative decision-making and strengthening immediate purchase urges (Beatty & Ferrell, 1998; Park & Lennon, 2006).

Positive emotions may increase impulse buying because pleasurable emotional states create an immediate desire for gratification. When consumers feel excited, happy, or enthusiastic while browsing fashion products, the psychological benefit associated with purchasing can become more salient than the potential benefits of delaying the decision. This is particularly relevant in e-commerce because the transaction process is highly convenient and can be completed almost immediately.

The result is also consistent with evidence from Indonesian fashion research. Zein and Hadi (2025) report a positive and significant effect of positive emotion on impulse buying in the Indonesian fashion industry. Similar evidence has been reported in studies examining shopping lifestyle, hedonic motivation, and positive emotion in Indonesian e-commerce. The consistency across studies suggests that positive emotional responses are not merely secondary consequences of online shopping but may constitute an important mechanism underlying spontaneous purchase behavior.

The relatively larger coefficient of positive emotions compared with the direct effects of hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle further suggests that consumers' immediate affective states may be more proximal to impulse buying than their broader motivational or lifestyle orientations. Hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle describe relatively general characteristics of consumers, whereas positive emotions represent the psychological state experienced closer to the moment of purchase. The finding therefore provides empirical support for positioning positive emotions as a proximal mechanism between consumer characteristics and impulse buying.

5.6 Positive Emotions as a Mediating Mechanism

The mediation results provide further insight into the mechanism underlying impulse buying. Positive emotions significantly mediate the relationship between hedonic motivation and impulse buying, as well as the relationship between shopping lifestyle and impulse buying. These findings indicate that consumers' motivational and lifestyle orientations are translated into impulsive purchasing partly through the positive emotional experiences generated during shopping.

The mediation between hedonic motivation and impulse buying can be understood as a sequential psychological process. Consumers who are motivated by pleasure and enjoyment are more likely to experience positive emotions during shopping. These positive emotions subsequently increase the likelihood of spontaneous purchasing. Thus, the effect of hedonic motivation is not limited to a direct tendency toward impulse buying; part of its influence operates through the emotional state experienced by consumers.

A similar mechanism applies to shopping lifestyle. Consumers who regard shopping as an important part of their lifestyle may experience greater enjoyment and emotional gratification during shopping. These positive emotions can then strengthen the tendency to make unplanned purchases. The finding is consistent with recent evidence from Indonesian fashion research showing that positive emotion can mediate relationships involving shopping lifestyle and impulse buying.

The mediation result is particularly important because it integrates the four constructs examined in this study into a coherent behavioral process. Hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle represent the antecedent conditions, positive emotions represent the internal psychological state, and impulse buying represents the behavioral response. This structure is consistent with the broader logic of stimulus–organism–response explanations of consumer behavior, in which consumer characteristics and shopping stimuli affect internal states that subsequently shape behavioral responses.

At the same time, the mediation findings should not be interpreted as demonstrating that positive emotions completely explain the effects of hedonic motivation or shopping lifestyle. The significant direct relationships between hedonic motivation and impulse buying and between shopping lifestyle and impulse buying remain present in the empirical model. Therefore, based on the available results, positive emotions should be understood as an important intervening mechanism rather than the sole explanation for impulse buying. The original analysis establishes significant indirect effects but does not provide sufficient additional evidence to classify the mediation more specifically as full or partial mediation.

5.7 Theoretical and Managerial Implications

Taken together, the findings provide three important implications. First, the results strengthen the consumer-behavior literature by demonstrating that impulse buying in fashion e-commerce is associated with both consumers' relatively stable orientations—hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle—and their immediate emotional experiences. This

supports a multidimensional understanding of impulse buying rather than treating it as a simple response to external promotional stimuli.

Second, the findings strengthen the role of positive emotions as an explanatory mechanism. The fact that positive emotions significantly mediate both relationships suggests that understanding how consumers feel during shopping is important for explaining why they purchase without prior planning. This extends the interpretation of impulse buying beyond cognitive decision-making and places affective experience at the center of the purchasing process.

Third, the findings provide practical implications for fashion retailers operating through e-commerce. Retailers may benefit from creating shopping experiences that are enjoyable, engaging, and emotionally appealing rather than relying exclusively on functional product information. Attractive product presentation, personalized recommendations, relevant fashion content, and an engaging browsing experience may help create positive emotional responses. However, these implications should be understood as mechanisms for improving consumer experience rather than as evidence that any particular marketing tactic directly causes impulse buying, since the present study does not separately test specific platform or promotional stimuli.

Overall, the findings suggest that impulse buying in fashion e-commerce is best understood as an emotionally embedded consumption response. Consumers who shop for pleasure or who regard shopping as an important lifestyle activity are more likely to experience positive emotions, and these emotions are subsequently associated with a greater tendency to make spontaneous purchases. This integrated interpretation provides a stronger explanation of the empirical results than considering each relationship independently.

5. Conclusions

This study examined the relationships among hedonic motivation, shopping lifestyle, positive emotions, and impulse buying in the context of fashion e-commerce in Indonesia. The findings provide consistent evidence that consumers' impulsive purchasing behavior is associated with both their shopping orientation and their emotional experiences. Hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle have significant positive effects on impulse buying, indicating that consumers who derive greater pleasure from shopping and regard shopping as an important part of their lifestyle are more likely to make unplanned fashion purchases.

The findings further demonstrate that both hedonic motivation and shopping lifestyle positively influence positive emotions. This indicates that consumers' motivations and lifestyle orientations shape not only their purchasing behavior but also their emotional experiences during the shopping process. Positive emotions, in turn, have a significant positive effect on impulse buying and represent the strongest direct relationship in the structural model. These results emphasize the importance of consumers' immediate affective states in explaining spontaneous purchasing behavior.

The mediation analysis provides additional evidence that positive emotions significantly mediate the relationships between hedonic motivation and impulse buying and between shopping lifestyle and impulse buying. Thus, the findings support an integrated explanation in which consumers' hedonic orientation and shopping lifestyle contribute to positive emotional experiences, which subsequently increase the tendency toward impulse buying. The model explains 56.3% of the variance in impulse buying, indicating meaningful explanatory capacity for the behavioral outcome examined in this study.

The study contributes to the literature by bringing motivational, lifestyle, and affective dimensions together within a single framework for understanding impulse buying in Indonesian fashion e-commerce. Rather than viewing impulse buying solely as a response to external shopping stimuli, the findings indicate that consumers' internal motivations and emotional experiences are important components of the process. For fashion e-commerce retailers, the findings suggest that creating enjoyable and emotionally engaging shopping experiences may be relevant to understanding consumers' spontaneous purchasing behavior.

Nevertheless, the findings should be interpreted within the scope of the research design. The study is based on 140 respondents selected purposively from consumers who engage in fashion purchases through e-commerce. Consequently, the findings should not be generalized beyond comparable consumer and e-commerce contexts without further empirical validation. Future research could extend the model by examining additional consumer characteristics, platform-related stimuli, promotional factors, or contextual variables that may further explain impulse buying behavior. Such extensions would help provide a more comprehensive understanding of how psychological and digital shopping environments jointly shape impulsive fashion consumption.

Funding

This research received no specific grant from any funding agency in the public, commercial, or not-for-profit sectors.

Competing Interests

The authors declare that they have no competing interests.

Authors' Contributions

All authors contributed equally to the conception and design of the study

Ethics Statement

This study was conducted in accordance with applicable ethical principles. Participation was voluntary, and respondents' anonymity and confidentiality were maintained throughout the study.

Use of Artificial Intelligence

Artificial Intelligence (AI)-based tools were used during the preparation of this manuscript for brainstorming ideas and refining language, grammar, and overall readability. The use of AI was limited to language and writing support. The authors remain fully responsible for the research design, data analysis, interpretation of the findings, theoretical arguments, and all final content of the manuscript. AI-generated suggestions were critically reviewed and verified by the authors before being incorporated into the manuscript.

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